

Deep Work — Revision Booklet

Cal Newport • 2-page rapid revision • Concepts → Mental model → Recall questions

30-second mental model: Read the bold chain below, then try to explain the book without looking at the page.

Attention → Ritual → Deep Block → High-Value Output → Skill

CORE CONCEPTS

- Deep work = distraction-free concentration on cognitively demanding work.
- Deep work creates valuable output and accelerates skill acquisition.
- Shallow work = logistical/routine work; contain it instead of letting it dominate.
- Attention residue makes task switching expensive.
- Create a ritual: Where? When? What? Rules? Finish line?

CORE CONCEPTS — CONTINUED

- Four rules: Work Deeply → Embrace Boredom → Control Your Tools → Drain the Shallows.
- Protect peak cognitive hours for high-value work.
- Use shutdown rituals to close open loops and recover.
- Depth requires training; concentration is a skill.

Deep Work — Active Recall

Close the book. Answer these from memory. Then revisit only the concepts you missed.

1. What is my highest-value deep-work task this week?

2. When is my best cognitive window?

3. Which distraction or shallow commitment should I eliminate?

One-sentence teach-back: Explain the entire book to someone in one sentence.

Top 3 ideas I will apply: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

Next review: _____ Score: ____ / 10